

Element A

A common complaint among incoming students, teachers, and visitors is that the temporary classrooms are hard to navigate. Especially at big schools like Eleanor Roosevelt High School, it is extremely difficult to navigate through the school already. Now, the addition of temporary classrooms in weird orders adds to this difficulty. According to the article “‘I Probably Cried Every Night’: The Truth About Supporting New Teachers,” it proves that even teachers, along with students, have difficulty navigating every class. To try and solve the issue, the design a map to showcase the layout of the temp classes. A QR code that directs any users to a list of teachers and where their classrooms are located in the temp area for extra, needed information would also benefit the design. “The high school is a lot bigger, so it took a bit to adjust to the high school, and I used a map for the first week,” said freshman Juniper L. (W., Samantha, 2024). Freshmen want a way to easily get around school without having to ask others for directions or get lost easily. In addition to freshmen, any new visitor to the school, such as a teacher or parent, needs a system to navigate through the classes, especially at additional temporary classes (temps). Students, teachers, and visitors can also develop mental challenges, such as anxiety, through the harsh integration of a big school and the challenging navigation of classes. This is inferred from “A new learning environment can create a challenge for high-schoolers. The high school may be larger than the middle school. And this means more area to get around when switching classrooms between classes.” (Morin 1). The students emphasize how hard it is to adjust to a new school, supporting the underlying fact that a device to help them navigate and integrate into this school would be this project; “Everything seemed bigger. Larger buildings, taller students, and higher stacks of homework. I felt lost at times, trying to remember the combination to my locker, where to go for my next class, and who to trust.” (Bergdall, Matt, 2018). Lastly, the map not only helps new individuals transition to finding their physical temps but a QR code will be accessible to figure out which teachers teach where. A QR code provides “bridging offline-to-online experiences, high-capacity data storage, easy creation, and secure, fast, 360-degree

scanning” (PayPal, 2023) This project will allow students, visitors, teachers, and more to navigate temporary classes and the teachers within the temps to transition more easily and efficiently.

The primary stakeholders for this community project are engineering teacher Dr. Paz, who will be overseeing the process, the clients affected by the solution (incoming freshmen, visitors, new admin, etc.), our parents, who will be contributing resources to the project, another engineering teacher, Mr. Nusum, and our mentor, Mr. John Carey, Evelyn’s father. By solving the problem of the confusing layout of the temp classes, we can prevent confusion and stress among students, teachers, and visitors alike. Specifically, the engineering teacher, Dr. Paz, will be supporting the project with materials, advice, insight, and more. Additionally, Mr. Nusum will be providing us with the resin for one of our considered materials and help us with plating the project in resin. The clients will be affected by the project, so they will give their personal values and views to change the project as they would like. The people contributing will be providing resources to the project, so they can give us feedback on how to improve and modify our project. Lastly, our mentor, Mr. Carey, will be leading the project and assisting until the full completion of the project.

Creating a map that is not just easy to understand, but also aesthetically pleasing and encouraging interaction would significantly improve users' experience of getting lost or confused. Instead of feeling unsure and discouraged about the layout of the temporary classrooms, users will be inspired to use the map to navigate the area. The added QR code with important and informative details will also be able to direct people to easy-access information. Since getting lost on campus is such a big issue among people, especially new students and faculty, this would be a good addition to the frankly limited amount of help they get. The only amount of assistance that people get when lost on campus is pretty much solely asking for help, since there isn’t an easily accessible campus map. It’s been explained how big a problem it is that “93% of students get lost on campus during their first months” (Mathieu, 2025). Some users might also already feel embarrassed or nervous asking for directions, and this could be beneficial for those with anxious feelings about that. Overall, creating this map for community partners will be able to limit not only getting lost, but also anxiety about the first few weeks to get familiar with the school facility.